

B2B Appointment Setting Script — SaaS & Services

Free cold-calling resource from Televista

PURPOSE: Bypass gatekeepers and book qualified meetings with decision makers. Works for SaaS companies, marketing agencies, staffing firms, IT services, and any B2B outbound team.

GATEKEEPER BYPASS

Technique 1 — Casual & Confident:

"Hey, this is [First Name] — is [Decision Maker First Name] around?"

[Say it like you know them. No company name, no title, no pitch. Gatekeepers are trained to filter salespeople, not peers.]

Technique 2 — Referral Frame:

"Hi, I was speaking with someone on your team and they suggested I connect with [Decision Maker]. Could you put me through?"

Technique 3 — Voicemail Route:

"I know [he/she] is probably busy — can you drop me into voicemail? I just need to leave a quick message."

[Then leave a strong 20-second voicemail — see below.]

If asked "What is this regarding?":

"It's about [a specific pain point relevant to their industry]. [He/She] will know what it's about."

DECISION MAKER OPENING

Do NOT lead with your product. Lead with their problem.

"[First Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. I'll be quick — I know you didn't expect this call. We work with [2-3 similar companies or competitors] to help them [specific outcome: reduce churn, cut CAC, fill their pipeline, etc.]. I had a quick question about how you're handling [specific pain point] — do you have 90 seconds?"

[If yes:] Move to qualification.

[If "What do you do?":] "In a sentence — we help [their role] at [their type of company] [achieve specific result]. But honestly, I don't even know yet if we're a fit. That's why I wanted to ask you a couple of questions first."

QUALIFICATION (BANT Framework)

1. NEED:

"How are you currently handling [pain point]? Is that something your team manages in-house, or do you have a vendor for that?"

"What's working? What's not?"

2. AUTHORITY:

"If you did decide to explore something like this, is that a decision you'd make, or would there be other stakeholders involved?"

[If others:] "Totally makes sense. Would it be helpful to include them in the conversation from the start?"

3. BUDGET:

"Do you have a budget allocated for [solving this problem / this type of solution], or would this be something you'd need to build a case for?"

[Don't push on exact numbers yet — save that for the meeting.]

4. TIMELINE:

"Is this something you're looking to address this quarter, or is it more of a long-term priority?"

OBJECTION HANDLING

OBJECTION: "We're not interested."

RESPONSE: "I hear you — and I wouldn't expect you to be interested in something you haven't seen yet. I'm not asking for a commitment. What if I showed you specifically how [competitor/similar company] solved [same problem]? If it's not relevant, I'll never call again. Fair?"

OBJECTION: "Send me an email."

RESPONSE: "Happy to — but I want to send you something that's actually relevant, not a generic deck. Quick question: is [pain point] something you're actively dealing with right now, or is it more of a future consideration? That way I can tailor what I send."

[Then send the email within 5 minutes and follow up 2 days later.]

OBJECTION: "We already have a solution for that."

RESPONSE: "Good — most companies at your stage do. Out of curiosity, how long have you been with them? And if there was one thing you could improve about the way it's working, what would it be?"

[Listen for dissatisfaction. If they're genuinely happy, note it and follow up in 6 months when their contract may be up for renewal.]

OBJECTION: "Call me back later."

RESPONSE: "Absolutely — when works best? I want to respect your time and not play phone tag. Would [specific day] at [specific time] work? I'll send a calendar invite so it's locked in."

[Always pin down a specific time. "Later" without a date is a dead end.]

MEETING BOOKING

"Based on what you've shared, I think it would be worth a 20-minute conversation with our [title — solutions engineer, account executive, founder, etc.]. They can show you exactly how we helped [similar company] [achieve specific result] and whether the same approach would work for you. No pitch, no pressure — if it's not a fit, we'll tell you. Would [Day] at [Time] or [Day] at [Time] work?"

[Confirm:] Send calendar invite immediately with a brief agenda. Include a one-pager or case study. Confirm attendees and decision makers.

VOICEMAIL SCRIPT (20 seconds max)

"[First Name], it's [Your Name] with [Company]. Quick message — we just helped [similar company] [specific result with a number]. I wanted to see if the same approach would work for you. My number is [number]. Again, [Your Name], [number]."

[Leave no more than 2 voicemails per prospect. After that, switch to email and LinkedIn touches.]

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